10 Best Stocks for Intraday Trading — A Plain-Language Guide

Based on 5.5 years of NSE minute-by-minute price data (2021-03 to 2026-09), 165 stocks, 12 different trading rules tested · generated 2026-09-25

> This document picks the 10 best-performing stock + strategy combinations found across an extensive research effort, explains — in plain terms, with no coding or trading jargon assumed — exactly what each underlying strategy actually does, and works through what a realistic monthly profit might look like if you traded all 10 with ₹1,00,000, including real trading costs and a sensible allowance for missed trades.

1. What is a "strategy" here?

A strategy is just a fixed, mechanical rule for deciding when to buy or sell a stock during the trading day — no guesswork, no gut feeling, the same rule applied the same way every single time. Three different rules produced the 10 best results, described below in plain language.

1. Opening Range Breakout

Right when the market opens at 9:15 AM, prices often swing around before settling into a real direction for the day. This rule watches the stock for the first 15 minutes (9:15–9:30 AM) and notes the highest and lowest price it touches — call this the **"opening range."** If, sometime before 9:45 AM, the price breaks *above* the top of that range while noticeably more shares than usual are trading hands, that's read as the stock genuinely starting to move up for the day — so we buy. If price breaks *below* the bottom of the range instead, we sell (this is called "shorting" — profiting if the price falls). Each stock is only checked for this once per day.

Used for: **ETERNAL, BDL**

2. Three-in-a-Row Momentum ("Strong Rally")

This rule looks at the stock's price in 5-minute chunks throughout the day. If the price moves up by at least 0.2% in three of these 5-minute chunks **in a row**, that's a real, steady push in one direction — not just random back-and-forth wobble. The instant we see that third consecutive strong move, we buy right at the start of the very next 5-minute chunk, betting the push continues a little further. The same idea works in reverse for three falling chunks in a row, where we'd sell instead.

Used for: **ADANIENT, INDHOTEL, HINDUNILVR**

3. Falling Below the Day's Average Price (sell-only, mid-morning)

"VWAP" stands for Volume Weighted Average Price — think of it as the fair average price the stock has traded at *so far today*, but weighted so that prices where a lot of shares changed hands count more than prices where only a few did. It's a good read on whether, overall, today has leaned toward buying or selling pressure. Alongside VWAP, we track two moving averages of the price — a fast one (the last 9 minutes) and a slower one (the last 21 minutes). When the fast average crosses *below* the slow one — a sign the very recent trend has just turned down — **and** the price is below today's VWAP **and** more shares than usual are trading, we sell, betting the stock keeps falling for a while longer. Only the sell (falling-price) version of this signal is used — testing found it noticeably more reliable than the buy side — and only after the first 45 minutes of the late-morning session, since very early signals proved weaker.

Used for: **APARINDS, OIL, NLCINDIA, KPITTECH, AWL**

2. Two numbers you'll see everywhere

Win rate

Out of every 100 times this rule triggered a trade, how many closed with a profit. A win rate of 45% means 45 out of 100 trades made money and 55 lost — which sounds bad, but is completely fine *if* the winning trades, on average, make noticeably more than the losing trades lose (which is the case for every stock below — losses are capped tightly by a stop-loss, while wins are allowed to run further).

Average profit per trade

The average price move, in percent, across every trade this rule took — winners and losers blended together. This is the single number that most honestly answers "does this actually make money," and it's the number the monthly profit calculation below is built from.

3. The 10 best stocks

Each stock below is shown with whichever of the three strategies worked best for it specifically — a different strategy can genuinely suit a different stock, which is exactly what this list demonstrates.

#1 **ETERNAL** (the company behind Zomato)

Strategy: Opening Range Breakout · 430 trades over 5.5 years · Win rate **44.0%** · Average profit per trade **+0.302%**

#2 **ADANIENT** (Adani Enterprises)

Strategy: Three-in-a-Row Momentum · 738 trades · Win rate **39.6%** · Average profit per trade **+0.188%**

#3 **APARINDS** (Apar Industries — cables & transformers)

Strategy: Falling Below VWAP (sell-only) · 471 trades · Win rate **48.2%** · Average profit per trade **+0.183%**

#4 **BDL** (Bharat Dynamics — defence manufacturer)

Strategy: Opening Range Breakout · 566 trades · Win rate **41.2%** · Average profit per trade **+0.183%**

#5 **INDHOTEL** (Indian Hotels — the Taj group)

Strategy: Three-in-a-Row Momentum · 514 trades · Win rate **41.2%** · Average profit per trade **+0.161%**

#6 **OIL** (Oil India — state-run oil & gas explorer)

Strategy: Falling Below VWAP (sell-only) · 465 trades · Win rate **46.2%** · Average profit per trade **+0.161%**

#7 **NLCINDIA** (NLC India — state-run mining & power)

Strategy: Falling Below VWAP (sell-only) · 469 trades · Win rate **49.7%** · Average profit per trade **+0.154%**

#8 **KPITTECH** (KPIT Technologies — automotive software)

Strategy: Falling Below VWAP (sell-only) · 406 trades · Win rate **49.5%** · Average profit per trade **+0.152%**

#9 **AWL** (AWL Agri Business, formerly Adani Wilmar)

Strategy: Falling Below VWAP (sell-only) · 342 trades · Win rate **57.9%** (best win rate of the 10) · Average profit per trade **+0.151%**

#10 **HINDUNILVR** (Hindustan Unilever)

Strategy: Three-in-a-Row Momentum · 128 trades (smallest sample — treat with extra caution) · Win rate **49.2%** · Average profit per trade **+0.145%**

4. Monthly profit calculation on ₹1,00,000 — step by step

Step 1 — how many trading signals do these 10 stocks produce, combined, per month?

Adding up all 10 stocks' trade counts over the 5.5-year (67-month) test period: **4,529 total trades**, which works out to **67.6 signals per month** if every single one could be acted on.

Step 2 — but you can't take every signal.

With ₹1,00,000, you're realistically trading one position at a time. Two different stocks can generate a signal within minutes of each other, and you can only act on one. As a working assumption (yours): **if 100 signals occur in a month, you'll actually manage to get into about 40 of them** — a 40% capture rate. Applied to 67.6 signals/month, that's:

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67.6 signals/month × 40% capture rate ≈ 27 trades/month you actually place
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Step 3 — average profit per trade, blended across all 10 stocks.

Weighting each stock's average profit by how often it actually trades (a stock with 738 trades counts more than one with 128), the blended average works out to **+0.181%** price move per trade, before costs.

Step 4 — subtract real trading costs.

Every trade has two "legs" — buying in, selling out — and each leg incurs brokerage, a securities transaction tax, exchange fees, GST, and stamp duty. On a ₹4,00,000 trade size (see Step 5), this totals approximately **₹188 per round trip, or 0.047% of the trade's value**:

Charge	Amount
Brokerage (both legs)	₹40
Securities Transaction Tax	₹100
Exchange fees	₹24
SEBI charges	₹1
Stamp duty	₹12
GST (18% on brokerage + fees)	₹12
Total per trade	**≈ ₹188 (0.047% of trade value)**

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0.181% (gross profit) − 0.047% (costs) = 0.134% net profit per trade
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Step 5 — apply intraday margin.

Intraday trading (MIS) lets a broker lend roughly 4× your capital for the day. So ₹1,00,000 of your own money controls about ₹4,00,000 worth of stock. A 0.134% price move on ₹4,00,000 is worth 4× more relative to your own ₹1,00,000:

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0.134% × 4 (leverage) = 0.536% return on your ₹1,00,000, per trade
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₹1,00,000 × 0.536% = ₹536 net profit per trade (average)
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Step 6 — put it together.

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27 trades/month × ₹536 per trade ≈ ₹14,500 per month
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Scenario	Monthly profit (₹)	As % of ₹1,00,000
Before trading costs (gross)	₹19,585	**19.6%**
After trading costs (net) — the realistic figure	**₹14,502**	**14.5%**

Read this before trusting that number. ₹14,500/month (14.5%) is a large number, and there are specific, important reasons it's likely optimistic:

- **These 10 stocks were hand-picked as the best 10 out of roughly 2,000 stock-and-strategy combinations tested.** When you search that widely and keep only the top performers, some of what looks best is genuine skill and some is simply luck — that's true of any such search, not a flaw specific to this one. A large research effort earlier in this project found that a strategy's very best-looking result on one slice of data regularly performed much worse once tested on more data (one stock's headline result fell by over 70% once retested on a larger sample).
- **The 40% "capture rate" in Step 2 is a reasonable assumption, not a measured fact** — real results will depend on how conflicts between simultaneous signals actually get resolved day to day.
- **Real order fills are usually slightly worse than backtested ones.** This research already found one real example where a trade's actual loss was larger than intended because price moved fast within a single 1-minute window.
- None of this has been tested with real money yet. Treat this as a well-reasoned estimate to plan around, not a guarantee.

A more conservative way to read this section: the *mechanism* (pick strong stock+strategy pairs, size positions with leverage, account for costs) is sound and the math is done correctly — but the actual monthly number, in practice, is more likely to land noticeably below 14.5% than above it.

Generated from the papertrader research pipeline · underlying data: 165 NSE stocks, 2021-03 to 2026-09, 0.75% stop-loss configuration · full per-trade detail queryable via run ids 59-70 in `data/papertrader.db` · source report: `research/stop-0.75pct-5yr/all-strategies.md`